

Philipp Hilbert. *Product Owner who bridges business intent and engineering delivery.*

Positioning, ten years of hands-on product ownership across defence, public sector, InsurTech, and healthcare – shipping in agile teams, aligning stakeholders, and keeping backlogs honest.

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§ WHY VOLKSWAGEN

Volkswagen Digital:Hub operates like a startup with the distribution reach of one of the world's largest manufacturers – a combination that demands genuine product ownership rather than proxy ticket management. The job description explicitly calls for someone who bridges business partners and development teams, translates vision into roadmaps, and uses data and KPIs to argue for priorities; that is the mode I have worked in for nearly a decade. The mention of SAFe as a plus is concrete: I have restructured delivery units under pressure and reintroduced sprint discipline in teams that had lost it. *That is precisely the environment where structured agile practice compounds fastest.*

§ AI-NATIVE STACK

Daily tools, not buzzwords.

- **Claude**, requirements drafting, edge-case generation, stakeholder narrative
- **GPT**, research synthesis and backlog refinement support
- **GitHub Copilot**, in-repo feature support and acceptance-criteria review
- **Cursor / VSCode**, spec-driven development and rapid prototyping
- **Lovable**, front-end prototype iteration
- **Framer**, design-heavy mockups and concept presentations

- **Gamma.app**, stakeholder and roadmap presentations
 - **n8n**, workflow automation and lightweight agentic loops
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§ TECHNICAL ENVIRONMENT

Shipped with, not just listed.

Kotlin with Spring Boot, Python, Django, JavaScript, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, REST APIs, Kubernetes, ArgoCD, Helm, OpenShift, Argo Workflows, Jenkins, Bitbucket, Git, dbt, Dagster, DuckDB, MicroStrategy, Redpanda, AngularJS, Ionic, low-code insurance platforms, CGM API integration, Shopware.

§ SIDE PROJECT

BACKTESTING ENGINE [GITHUB.COM/HILBERTP](https://github.com/HilbertP) →

Personal crypto market backtesting and algorithmic trading research environment.

- Ingests historical market data across centralised and decentralised venues and runs strategy simulations against real price history.
 - Built on a file-queue-based agent loop with Python at the core, designed for iterative strategy development without external dependencies.
 - Actively used to analyse execution concepts including slippage, price impact, funding rates, and liquidation mechanics.
 - Demonstrates the kind of data-driven hypothesis testing and metrics-first thinking the VW role requires for product decision support.
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§ HOW I WOULD WORK AT VOLKSWAGEN

First weeks, concrete.

WEEK 1

Listen, map, find the gaps.

Attend every active ritual, read the existing backlog top-to-bottom, and hold one-on-ones with each engineer and business partner to understand where the roadmap intent and the sprint reality diverge.

WEEK 2

Sharpen the backlog.

Run a structured refinement session to split overgrown epics, attach acceptance criteria to the top ten items, and surface the two or three blockers causing the most invisible drag.

WEEK 3 +

Ship and close loops.

Own the first delivery increment end-to-end – from aligned user story through review – and establish a lightweight KPI read-out rhythm so stakeholders see real progress against the roadmap, not just velocity numbers.

I COVER LETTER

Dear Volkswagen Digital:Hub team,

I am applying for the Product Owner role at Volkswagen Digital:Hub in Spain. The description matches the kind of work I do best: sitting at the intersection of business intent and engineering delivery, maintaining a healthy backlog, and keeping a distributed team aligned on a shared vision – all without losing sight of the data that tells you whether you are actually moving in the right direction.

In my most recent role at Rohde & Schwarz, I owned a central AI and data management platform inside the FCAS European defence programme. The challenge was not the technology; it was translating ambiguous requirements from multinational stakeholders into clear, actionable user stories and then unblocking the team when infrastructure complexity threatened delivery. I reduced deployment times from several days to under forty minutes by introducing GitOps with ArgoCD – not because I was the engineer, but because I understood the problem well enough to make the case and then support the implementation. That is the kind of bridge work I understand this role to require.

At Emil Group, an InsurTech SaaS platform, I inherited a situation that will be familiar to many product teams: a bloated sprint, low trust from clients, and rising attrition on the engineering side. I split a seventeen-person team into focused Scrum units, reintroduced velocity tracking and structured refinement, and rebuilt client trust through weekly product workshops. By the time I left, senior developer attrition had dropped to a single departure. I mention this because the job description specifically calls for someone who can model agile working and create a strong feedback culture – that is not a soft aspiration for me; it is something I have had to rebuild under pressure.

On the stakeholder side, I am comfortable presenting to both technical and non-technical audiences. I have a spoken English sample on YouTube from my time at Qcrypt AG, where I was also deputy IT security officer and product owner of a quantum-secure encryption product that required no technical knowledge from the end user. Keeping complex product logic accessible is something I take seriously.

I am a German national, currently based in Berlin, and open to the fully remote setup you describe. My notice period is four weeks. I would welcome a conversation about how I can contribute to the Volkswagen Digital:Hub team.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*

II CURRICULUM VITAE

§ BEARING

Product Manager and Product Owner with nearly ten years of experience turning complex business requirements into shipped software across regulated, enterprise, and startup environments. Has owned roadmaps, backlogs, and cross-functional delivery teams in defence, public sector analytics, InsurTech SaaS, and mobile healthcare. Comfortable operating where requirements are incomplete, stakeholders are distributed, and the team needs a clear product direction to stay productive. Brings strong agile discipline, KPI-driven prioritisation, and the technical fluency to work credibly alongside engineers without displacing them.

§ CORE STRENGTHS

- Backlog ownership and sprint discipline under pressure
- Cross-functional stakeholder alignment, business to engineering
- Translating operational complexity into dev-ready requirements
- Agile ritual facilitation and team restructuring
- KPI and OKR-driven roadmap prioritisation
- Workshop facilitation with technical and non-technical audiences
- Rapid prototyping and hypothesis testing with AI-native tools
- Data-backed argumentation for product decisions
- Founder-level pragmatism and low-ego delivery ownership

§ PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

ROHDE & SCHWARZ 2024, 2025

Product Manager, AI Data Transformation

- Led cross-functional delivery team (architect, data scientists, backend/frontend engineers, QA) on a central AI and data management platform for multimodal datasets within the FCAS European defence programme
 - Delivered autonomous feature sets end-to-end: user stories, acceptance criteria, implementation support, testing, and GitOps-based rollout
 - Reduced deployment times from several days to 20–40 minutes by introducing GitOps with ArgoCD
 - Responsible for data transformation, transparency, and auditability with multinational stakeholders
 - Improved data quality via filtering, tagging, reproducible transformation pipelines, and audit trails with full data provenance
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FEDERAL EMPLOYMENT AGENCY (BUNDESAGENTUR FÜR ARBEIT) 2023, 2024

Product Manager, Public Data Analytics

- Advanced the Arbeitsmarktmonitor analytics platform, delivering new features including labour shortage analytics, flexible regional comparison, and modernised admin tooling
 - Introduced Dagster for automated ETL and indicator generation, standardised CI/CD with full test integration at build time
 - Served as Deputy IT Security Officer with focus on compliance, governance, and data lineage
 - Migrated legacy systems to Kubernetes and managed major system upgrades
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EMIL GROUP 2022, 2022

Product Manager, InsurTech SaaS Platform

- Re-established sprint discipline and delivery stability; split a bloated 17-person team into smaller, focused Scrum units and introduced ownership and deputy concepts
- Reintroduced velocity tracking and structured refinement practices lost under delivery pressure
- Regained client trust in a prototype-stage environment through structured communication and weekly product workshops

- Reduced senior developer attrition from near-total to a single departure
 - Designed and delivered a Claims Center module from concept to production rollout across a B2B platform serving primary insurers, reinsurers, MGAs, and brokers
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CLINET PLATFORMS 2021, 2022

Product Owner, Mobile Healthcare App

- Delivered core flows for digital anamnesis, meal and therapy plans, transport, chat, and patient document storage on iOS and Android
 - Built stakeholder trust through transparent communication of technical complexity involving legacy APIs and external databases
 - Led a small team under tight deadlines with strict focus on the highest-leverage features
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AOK HEALTH INSURANCE / ITSCARE 2019, 2020

Proxy Product Owner

- Owned migration of internal webshop to Shopware, including complex catalogue and API integration and customisable approval policies
 - Managed cross-functional delivery across business and technical stakeholders in a regulated health insurance environment
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BUNDESDRUCKEREI 2021, 2021

Product Owner, COVID-19 Data Platform

- Delivered RKI projects DIM and DESH: secure data structures and identity management for public health reporting infrastructure
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§ FOUNDER & EARLY-STAGE EXPERIENCE

QCRYPT AG 2016, 2018

Co-Founder and Product Owner

- Owned product architecture for backup, restore/checkpoint, and data-encryption modules of a quantum-secure encryption product based on one-time-pad keys and true random number generator hardware

- Served as deputy IT security officer; USP was setup under two minutes requiring no technical knowledge from end users
- Presented product to enterprise and government audiences in English and German

KVITT PAYMENT SOLUTIONS 2013, 2018

Founder and CFO

- Built a group-based P2P payment product on a P2P backbone; owned PSP integration, full UX/UI design, and mobile app prototype
- Product was later acquired and operated by Sparkasse

SMART SOIL TECHNOLOGIES 2016, 2021

Co-Founder, CDO, CFO, Head of HR (sequential roles)

- Established digital tooling, financial planning, investor relations, and ERP introduction for a nanotechnology vertical farming startup

§ LANGUAGES

German, native. English, C2.

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